

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyappakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills



RUDRAPPASAMY SCHOOL

— In pursuit of comprehensive learning —

Academic Support by Maharishi Vidya Mandir

ADMISSIONS
OPEN

2026 -27

Pre KG | LKG | UKG

Special Features

- ✓ Smart Classrooms
- ✓ Individual Attention
- ✓ CCTV Surveillance
- ✓ Hygienic & Secure Campus
- ✓ Fun Events & Celebrations
all through the year
- ✓ Cambridge Curriculum



Activity based
Learning



Safe & Child
Friendly
Environment



Music, Dance &
Story Telling



Strong Academic
Foundation



Play - Learn - Grow
Approach



Limited Seats Available - Enroll Today!

Call for
Enquiry

95000 23350
96000 31000

📍 57/2, Pattravakkam, Ambattur,
Chennai - 600053

✉ info@rudraschools.org

FROM CLASSROOMS TO THE WORLD – PREPARE YOUR CHILD FOR SUCCESS!



www.rudraschools.org

Dream, Believe, Achieve
Your child deserves the best start!

Pre KG - Grade IX & XI

Open Now 2026-27
CBSE school

- Meditation - Yoga
- Robotics, AI & Coding
- Art and Crafts
- Movement
(Bunny, Scouts & Guides, Cubs & Bulbul)

Special Activities

- Karate (3rd Std Onwards)
- Silambam • Gymnastics

- Music & Instruments
- Sports
(Football, Badminton, Athletic, Table Tennis, Carrom, Throwball & Kho - kho)
- Leader in me (7 Habits) Program
- Western Dance | Classical Dance
- Archery | Chess | Band | Guitar etc..

Cambridge Curriculum for Kindergarten

Cambridge Exams - Starters | Movers | Flyers | KET | PET | FCE

Olympiad Exams - IMO & NSO | Cyber Olympiad - Computer Science



**RUDRAPPASAMY
SCHOOL**

— In pursuit of comprehensive learning —

Call for Enquiry

CBSE School in Ambattur

95000 23350
96000 31000

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyappakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills



TRAVELLING LONG TO GET INKED

Over the last two to three weeks, migrant workers in Chennai have been etching travel plans to vote in their hometowns. Associations representing them are seeking additional trains to ensure their long journey to the voting booth is smooth. **P4**

'Address congestion on CTH Road'

This is on top of the wish list United Welfare Associations – Ambattur has been presenting to poll candidates: a link road from the Perungalthur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass to the Patravakkam service lane



The Padi stretch of CTH Road on December 19, 2025. PHOTO: B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

S. SURESH

Decongestion of CTH Road tops the list of election demands of United Welfare Associations - Ambattur, a citizens group in Ambattur Assembly Constituency.

Towards this end, the association had identified three measures that ought to be taken. First, it wants a road that links Perungalthur - Puzhal Chennai Bypass Road to its service lane in Patravakkam near Kallikuppam.

Such an arrangement will divert a sizeable segment of traffic towards Ambattur Industrial Estate, Porur, Tambaram, and beyond via the bypass road without taking CTH Road. This will make a world of a difference.

Next, it wants to fast-track

the CTH Road widening project, announced in 2013 but still at the land acquisition stage.

The third measure is the widening of ROB near TI Cycles. Funds were allocated in 2022, but the work has not commenced to this day.

Regular users know how trying driving can be on CTH Road, especially during the rush hour. Traffic crawls on this stretch, especially near Mannurpet, Canara Bank junction, and Padi sections. Therefore, these three measures should be executed without much delay. Otherwise, conditions are likely to worsen further once metro rail work begins on CTH Road. Battered roads have aggravated the problem. The stretches near Mannurpet and Telephone Exchange junction are a few examples. They are marked by

potholes and known for waterlogging. It may be noted that according to a Ministry of Road Transport & Highways report in 2019, Telephone Exchange junction was categorised as a black spot due to a staggering number of accidents that had occurred at the spot. To this day, no remedial measures have been taken.

Decongestion of CTH Road has been our demand for the past several years but it remains unaddressed.

Other demands include shifting of Ambattur bus terminus to a spacious locality in Pudur, establishment of a government college, a government school for boys, and a government hospital, and a sprawling playground near Rail Vihar.

S. Suresh, president, United Welfare Associations of Ambattur

'Speed breakers needed'



Francis Colony Second Main Road in Madhavaram. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

NASSER NISSAR MOHAMMED

After a year-long complaint, a speed breaker was laid on April 3, 2026 on Francis Colony Second Main Road in Madhavaram. But there is no marking to indicate its presence. Further, there is no compliance with the guidelines prescribed by the Indian Road Congress. Besides, two more speed breakers are necessary on this road. Because this is a residential area and a good number of

children play on the road. This road witnesses good traffic including trucks and water lorries as it provides connectivity to Madhavaram-Red Hills Road from where Moolakadai junction can be accessed.

It may be noted there were speed breakers on this road until a couple of years ago but they were done away with following a road-relaying work.

Nasser Nissar Mohammed is a resident of Madhavaram

20

... YEARS ...

Anniversary

CELEBRATIONS

13-04-2026

THIS JOURNEY WAS NEVER OURS ALONE.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR CONTINUES SUPPORT

Enjoy a surprise gift on every purchase!

From March 25th To April 13th

ANNA NAGAR EAST:
Chinthamani, C100, 1ST AVENUE,
Annanagar East, Chennai - 600 102.
Ph: 90254 04352

MC ROAD:
NO.97, MC Road, NN Garden,
Old Washermanpet, Chennai - 600 021.
Ph: 90254 04354

Terms & Conditions apply

‘Chettiyar Agaram Road need speedbreakers’



Chettiyar Agaram Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

KARTHIYALINI SENTHILNATHAN

Chettiyar Agaram Road in Vanagaram was relaid around four months ago. It is an immense relief for the regular users because over the years, the road was marked with potholes and therefore prone to water-logging.

However, speed breakers have not been laid. This road witnesses good traffic because it connects Mount Poonamalle in Porur on one end and Perunga-

lathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass in Vanagaram at the other. Further, Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Wetland Eco Park which opened a year ago is located on this road.

Motorists come at a fast clip, especially near Osian Chlorophyll apartment and near the park and there have been close calls. Appropriate safety measures should therefore be provided on this road without much delay.

Karthiyalini Senthilnathan is a resident of Vanagaram

‘Late night train services to Avadi deviate from timetable’

ANU NANDHANA M

Regular commuters notice a 20-minute delay in the operation of the following late night sub-urban train services in the last six months: 43613 (Chennai Beach - Avadi) and 66005 (Chennai Central - Avadi). While the train 43613 is supposed to depart from Chennai Beach at 10.05 p.m. and arrive at Avadi at 11 p.m., the train 66005 is expected to depart from Chennai Central at 10.20 p.m. and arrive at Avadi at 11.05 p.m.

But both trains do not stick to the timetable. Even when the train 66005 departs from Chennai Central on time, it is stopped before Vyasarpadi railway station and made to wait until the delayed train 43613 Chennai Beach-Avadi passes. Only after train 43613 clears the section does train 66005 allowed to proceed.

The delay causes various diffi-



Avadi railway station. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

culties for the commuters.

Commuters request Southern Railway authorities to do the need-

ful and ensure there is no delay.

Anu Nandhana M is a resident of Avadi

‘Delay in relaying milled road’

M. SENTHIL

Greater Chennai Corporation milled Third Cross Street which is off South Red Hills Road in Villivakkam during the first week of March. But it has not been relaid to this day.

Citing the Election of Conduct, which came into effect on March 15, 2026, the roadwork has not been resumed.

The milling was carried out at a time when we were all expecting the announcement of the election dates by the Election Commission of India sooner or later.

So the commencement of the road work could have been kept on hold. Now, it is extremely difficult to use the road. This road has many bends and one has to be extremely cautious while navigating it.

This road is near Villivakkam station and market and it provides connectivity to SIDCO Nagar Fourth Main Road, a key road in Villivakkam that leads to MTH Road. Therefore it witnesses good traffic.

M. Senthil is a resident of Villivakkam

Third Cross Street which is off South Red Hills Road in Villivakkam. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



You can be our volunteer writer



Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number

Danger lurks on service road in Karambakkam

R. MURUGESAN

The stormwater drain on the Karambakkam section of the service lane in Porur on Perungalathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass (near Vanagaram tollgate) remains uncovered and in some stretches it is broken. This is quite unsafe because the drain doubles as footpath in the narrow lane. The service road witnesses heavy traffic due to the presence of many residential colonies in the vicinity.

Further, flouting of the one-way rule on the service road, especially by motorcyclists, aggravates the problem for pedestrians as they are pushed to the edge of the stormwater drain which is wide open and also gives room for head-on colli-



The Karambakkam section of the service lane of Perungalathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass.

PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

sions. When the metro rail services in Porur stretch are set in operation, there will be a spurt in the traffic on the service road because there is a metro rail station nearby.

R. Murugesan is a resident of Karambakkam

Hummer comes to India

Hummer, a US-based car battery jump starter, has entered the Indian market. The car jump starter stands out for its specifications, build quality, reliability, and safety features that protect both the dev-

ice and the vehicle, said a press release.

The starter can also be used as a power bank for phones, laptops, inverters, and tire inflators, the release added.



THE HINDU GROUP



EVERY BIG CAREER BEGINS WITH ONE RIGHT STEP.

The 23rd edition of *The Hindu Education Plus Career Counselling 2026* is a two-day career guidance event that connects students directly with leading universities and colleges across India.

Attend expert-led seminars, and get personalised counselling. Everything you need to make an informed choice is now in one place.



VIT
CHENNAI

Presents

THE HINDU
EDUCATION PLUS
GET THE EDGE

career
counselling
fair '26

Powered by



In Association with



UNLOCK
ATTRACTIVE
PRIZES!*

Attend the sessions and join the On-spot skill contests to win exciting prizes.

SPOT
ADMISSIONS & SCHOLARSHIPS



April 11 & 12, 2026 | 10 AM onwards
Chennai Trade Centre, Nandambakkam

To register,
scan the QR code or visit
newsth.live/THEPCFPCA



For more details: **90940 41021 | 99622 26550 | 98412 98938**

*T & C apply

Associate Partners





Over the last two to three weeks, migrant workers in Chennai have been etching travel plans to vote in their hometowns. Associations representing them are seeking additional trains to ensure their long journey to the voting booth is smooth



ILLUSTRATION SATHESH VELLINEZH

Travelling long to get inked

LIFFY THOMAS

When election dates were announced on March 15, Kottivakkam resident and general secretary of Confederation of Tamilnadu Malayalee Associations Anwar M.P. was furiously scrolling down IRCTC website to book four train tickets to his hometown in Kannur district of Kerala. A resident of Chennai for the last three decades, the businessman makes travel plans to his native place every election season (that includes panchayat elections) sufficiently ahead of time.

Kerala goes to the hustings on April 9, as do Assam and Puducherry. Further down the “poll procession” are Tamil Nadu (April 23) and West Bengal (April 23 and 29).

Travel plans are being meticulously etched by residents of Chennai with their votes parked in other states. And associations representing the interests of those from these states who have “pitched tent” in Chennai for work and business note that with intervention by the Tamil Nadu government and Southern Railway, these travel plans need not

be as stressful as they currently are.

The Confederation of Tamilnadu Malayalee Associations has made a representation to the State Government to run additional trains to clear the rush of migrants wanting to vote in their hometowns. “This year, we made the representation more than two months ago so that there is ample time to press more trains into service,” says Anwar.

While Southern Railway does operate special trains during festivals and election season, many say the announcement on additional trains is made at the eleventh hour, which detracts from the usefulness of this exercise.

As Easter, Assembly Polls and Vishu come in quick succession, Anwar says there’s demand for bus

Poll-related travel plans are not always about tickets. Soaring prices of flight tickets around this time and lack of certainty about train tickets are encouraging voters to undertake long road trips to cast the ballot

and train tickets to Kerala.

Natvar Thidar, aged 44 and working as a cook in Chennai for the last 15 years, notes: “I paid extra money to an agent and got a confirmed ticket on Coromandel Express.”

“There are less number of trains to north Malabar and towards Mangalore, so we have made a representation to run trains on these routes in particular. We also need Vande Bharat on this network,” says Anwar.

A similar demand has been raised by the Assam Association Chennai, they want additional Durgam Express/Rajdhani Express/

Vande Bharat Express to Guwahati.

Mini Bengal in Chennai

In Sowcarpet and Park Town, Tarun Kumar Das has been working with the community of Bengalis to encourage them to travel to their hometown to cast their vote. He says there are close to 30,000 Bengalis working mainly with gold manufacturing outlets. “At least 70%

of them have their vote in Bengal and we have already started speaking to them to see if they can start making arrangements to travel home,” says Das, who is vice-president of Rexine and Bag Manufacturer Traders Association - Tamil Nadu and vice-president of the Bengal Association.

Das says the Southern Railway must run additional trains to cater to such rush from people. “The construction industry employs a number of people from Bengal and there should also be some initiative from the industry so that they can also be part of elections,” he adds.

Tamil Nadu Labour Welfare and Skill Development Department has already issued instructions that all employers across industries and commercial establishments, including private sector, shops and factories, must grant paid holiday to employees, casual workers and daily wage earners to travel to their hometowns when voting happens in their states.

‘Vote vandi’

And poll-related travel plans are not always about tickets. Soaring prices of flight tickets around this time and lack of certainty about train tickets are encouraging voters to undertake long road trips to cast the ballot. Increasingly many people are seen coming together to hire a bus or van and travel together. Anwar says he has noticed this trend in the last three years, where people pool in money and book a vehicle that will reach their hometown on voting day and they return on the same bus. Adds Anwar: “They are called “vote vandi” (vote bus).”

Best Bargains

SOFA SERVICE
ANY SOFA'S
RECLINER SOFAS
CUSHIONS
REUPHOLSTERY
Reconditioning @
Very Moderate Charges
K.N.S. RAJAN SERVICES
76671 33233
93818 03956

PRINTZ CARE
Exclusive Shop For Refilling & Printer Service
PRINTER
SERVICE
INKJET & TONER
REFILLING
We REPAIR all
inkjet & laser printers
ON SPOT
DOOR STEP SERVICE
NOW AVAILABLE
PICK-UP & DROP
98946 55595

JVR Academy
Online Summer Crash Course -
May 2026
Learning Spoken Hindi
Is made EASY.
Learn spoken conversational
HINDI in 20 days (daily 2 hrs)
through Tamil & English
medium, no Hindi letters.
Above 8th std & NO AGE LIMITS.
Contact: Vimala Radhakrishnan
9940365965

**MATHS & PHYSICS
TUITION**
CBSE/ ICSE/ ISC
IGCSE/ GCSE-EDEXCEL
AS/ A- Level
IB-HL/SL-AA/AI
All International Boards
9th, 10th, 11th, 12th
VITEEE 2026
25+ Years Experienced Faculty
95786 67776

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN
Contact:
SATHIYAMORTHY
70927 03458

The Hindu EducationPlus Career Counselling Fair on April 11 and 12

The Hindu EducationPlus is conducting the 23rd edition of *The Hindu EducationPlus* Career Counselling Fair on April 11 and 12 from 10 a.m. to 6 p.m. at the Chennai Trade Centre, Convention Hall.

The exhaustive fair for parents and students from classes 9 to 12 will empower aspiring young minds to make informed career decisions from 40 plus institutions and help them choose the right courses and colleges.

Top educational and financial institutions from across India will be present. Furthermore, career guidance sessions with domain experts will help people discuss their career plans.

This annual fair is a great chance for students and parents to explore different career paths, learn about college admissions, and gain insights into various fields of study.

A plethora of options awaits students as they get ready to finish their schooling, much more than ever before. There are a wide range of courses to choose from, careers to aspire to, and areas of interest to delve into.

In every edition, the fair has aimed to give students insights into several areas, cater to their interests, and open a world of educational opportunities for them.

The latest edition of the career



tact: +91 90940 41021, 9962226550 and 9841298938.

“VIT Chennai presents *The Hindu Education Plus* Career Counselling Fair 2026” is powered by Hindustan Group of Institutions, Chennai and Rajalakshmi Institute of Technology, In Association with B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science & Technology and SRM Institute of Science & Technology, Tiruchirapalli. Associate partners are Amet University, Bharath Institute of Higher Education and Research, GRT Institute of Engineering and Technology, Mee-nakshi Academy of Higher Education & Research (MAHER), Symbiosis Skills and Professional University, Pune, The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India, Vels Institute of Science, Technology & Advanced Studies (VISTAS) and Vinayaka Mission's Research Foundation, Chennai Campus.

To register: <https://newsth.live/THEPCFCED> or scan the QR code:



counselling fair will have all of this and make this experience possible for students by giving them the platform to engage with experts across diverse fields and representatives from various educational and financial institutions. Keeping up with the needs of the students, *The Hindu Education-Plus* has been organising career expos to aid students looking to pursue higher education both in India and overseas.

Spot admissions and scholarships await the students at the fair along with surprise gifts for the first 200 entries on both the days. To know more about the sessions and the fair, con-

Free career-readiness course

Chevalier T. Thomas Elizabeth College for Women is conducting a series of free crash courses for girl students of class VIII onwards.

The programme is scheduled to be conducted from April 7 to 10, between 9.30 a.m. and 1 p.m.

The initiative seeks to enhance students' employability skills, critical thinking, domain knowledge, and career

readiness through practical and student-centred learning approaches.

Sessions will be offered across a range of disciplines, including Tally and FinTech, MS Office and digital marketing, psychology, career guidance, current affairs, culture and personality development, and AI tools.

For details, call 044 2537 5753

Workshop for women and children

Artist Kanimozhi's next batch will begin on April 6. She takes classes in Tanjore paintings and other traditional Indian art forms, including Madhubani, Warli, Gond, Patachitra, Nirmal, Zulu, Kerala Mural, and Rajasthani paintings. The workshop is open to women and children and will be conducted at SAF Games Village, Koyambedu. For details, contact Kanimozhi at 9381157831

Screening for people with Parkinson's

April marks World Parkinson's Awareness Month, highlighting the need to increase understanding of Parkinson's. Parivarthan for Parkinson's Foundation works actively to raise awareness and create a safe, supportive space for people living with

Parkinson's and their families. As part of its awareness efforts this April, Parivarthan is organising a Deep Brain Stimulation (DBS) screening session for people with Parkinson's on April 11.

For more details and registration, contact 96000 52531.

Cultural events at Chennai Public School

Chennai Public School, Anna Nagar, celebrated its Annual Day and graduation ceremony for its primary students recently at Kama-

rajar Arangam. According to a press release, the theme for this year celebration was “ODYSEA - The Voices of the Ocean.” Dance, music, and

skits marked the event. Further, the annual report was presented through an audio-visual mode which highlighted the achievements through the academic year, adds the release.

Doctor consultation at home



A group of doctors has started two initiatives that benefit the public. They are the 'DrBro - Doctors2Home' and 'Evening clinic @ your home'. Under 'DrBro - Doctors2Home', doctors, along with nurses, would visit homes to treat common illnesses such as fever, colds, stomach pain, blood pressure and sugar.

In 'Evening clinic @ your home', doctors would visit homes within a five-kilometre radius of Virugambakkam.

The benefits of the initiatives include avoiding waiting time at the clinics and travel cost. It benefits children, working professionals and senior citizens, said a release.

Apart from the initiatives, they offer medicines, injections, IV fluids and lab tests at 10 percent discount.

For details, call or WhatsApp 7338830305 or 7338830905.

LEARN TO SWIM **SUMMER CAMP**

"Learn and Practice Swimming at young age and lead a healthy Life for Ever"

SDAT DOLPHIN SWIMMING ACADEMY
TALENT IDENTIFICATION PROGRAM
LEARN TO SWIM CLASSES

Timings	1st Batch	2nd Batch	3rd Batch	4th Batch	5th Batch	6th Batch	7th Batch	Timings
Morning	24th March to 9th April	10th April to 26th April	28th April to 14th May	15th May to 31st May	2nd June to 18th June	19th June to 5th July	7th July to 23rd July	Evening
6 to 7 am								3 to 4 pm
7 to 8 am								4 to 5 pm
8 to 9 am								5 to 6 pm
9 to 10 am								
10 to 11 am								
11 to 12 pm								

CLASSES CONDUCTED PROFESSIONALLY
State Sports Complex, Block 8, Mogappair West, Chennai-37
94449 06878 / 94449 55878 / 79027 08095
93450 04088 / 044-2653 4211
CLASSES FREE FOR UNDERPRIVILEGED STUDENTS

FREE SIGN BOARD FOR APARTMENTS BY #1 USA JUMPSTARTER

PARTEL - NATIONAL DISTRIBUTOR HUMMER

Self Start Yourself on Battery Death anytime... anywhere...

Whatsapp : 9884444411 / 8778959169

பாஸ்போர்ட் சர்வீசஸ் **PASSPORT SERVICES**

Vaigai Wings
The Dependable Travel Service

Crescent Court, 963 Periyar EVR High Road, Chennai - 600 084, India

Tel: +91 7338791804 | +91 6384552233 | +91-44-26413126

Email: welcome@vaigai.com | Website: <https://www.vaigai.com>

GAYATHRI PHARMACY

GET YOUR BRANDED MEDICINE AT YOUR DOORSTEP

ALL MEDICINES 20% DISCOUNT
(For Medicines Purchase Above Rs.1,000)

HOME DELIVERY AVAILABLE All Over Chennai

7845998336, 93611 46912, 044 3594 7644



A **TATA** PRODUCT

TANISHQ
Hues
natural gemstones,
vibrant colours

Celebrate this Akshaya Tritiya with Tanishq. Discover emeralds, pink tourmalines, and other natural gemstones reimagined in modern designs. For the woman who makes the world brighter wherever she goes.

UP TO **20% OFF***
On making charges of gold jewellery and on diamond value

FLAT **₹201 OFF***
per gram on gold jewellery purchase
Offer period: 10th-20th April, 2026

FESTIVAL OF EXCHANGE
MAKE THE SMART CHOICE
GET 100%* EXCHANGE VALUE



*Gold Rate Protection – book in advance and stay protected against increasing gold rate.



36 LAKH INDIANS TURNED THEIR OLD GOLD INTO INDIA'S NEW STRENGTH

Today, India imports 99% of its gold. You can help reduce imports by exchanging your old gold.

— GOLD —
EXCHANGE



Old gold from any jeweller accepted.



Year-round Exchange.



Choose from more than 10,000 designs.

To locate your nearest store and know more on 8147349242. Buy online at tanishq.co.in or Download our App *Conditions apply.

Showrooms at: **ANNA NAGAR** - Tel: 7845988359, 044 2619 4810 **PURASAIWAKAM** - Tel: 9500055244, 044 4350 1234 **PERAMBUR** - Tel: 9884932371, 044 3551 2722
MADURAVAYOL - Tel: 9363214316, 094896 30444 **AMBATTUR** - Tel: 044 43564477 **AVADI** - Tel: +91 9123552983 **TIRUVALLUR** - Tel: 6374464530, 098433 37789